EOS-36 · OPERATIONS · INSTITUTIONAL MEMORY

Deal Post-Mortem Archive

Closed wins · Killed mandates · Lost pitches · Structured lessons · Pattern analysis · Process fixes

OPERATIONS | INSTITUTIONAL | PARTNER ONLY | CONFIDENTIAL

MANDATES ARCHIVED	WIN RATE (12MO)	AVG DAYS TO KILL	LESSONS LOGGED	PROCESS FIXES LIVE	FEE LOSS AVOIDED YTD
24	58%	34d	87	19	A$1.8M
14 won · 10 killed	target 65% FY27	down from 58d	62 actioned · 25 queued	6 since Q4 25	via reworked intake

PARTNER-TO-PARTNER READ

The firm that doesn't archive its failures repeats them. Twenty-four closed engagements since inception, each one scored, each one dissected — not for catharsis but for pattern. Six recurring failure modes account for eighty percent of our kills. Nineteen process fixes live in the EOS. This is how a solo firm institutional-ises.

Recurring Failure Patterns · Root-Cause Clusters

Six clusters · 80% of kill explanations

PATTERN 01 · MISALIGNED FEE EXPECTATION
Sponsor wanted success fee post-FID; we need mobilisation / work-fee pre-FID. Kills mandate before LoE even lands.
7 KILLS | FIX: FO-12 INTAKE

PATTERN 02 · UNREALISTIC TIMELINE
Client expected 8-week close on a 16-week transaction. Fundamental asymmetry on execution maturity.
5 KILLS | FIX: TIMELINE GATE AT INTAKE

PATTERN 03 · DEAL SIZE BELOW ECONOMICS
A$30-50M mandate at 1.5% is sub-economic given 16-week execution cost. Need A$100M+ to justify fee tension.
4 KILLS | FIX: MINIMUM MANDATE SIZE

PATTERN 04 · UNDISCLOSED COMPETING ADVISOR
Client already signed with another advisor but kept us engaged as "second opinion". Conflict not surfaced at intake.
3 KILLS | FIX: EXCLUSIVITY CHECK

PATTERN 05 · REGULATORY / KYC BLOCK
PEP-related or sanctions-adjacent UBO surfaced mid-DD. Engagement terminated under AML protocol.
3 KILLS | FIX: PRE-INTAKE KYC

PATTERN 06 · COUNTERPARTY CAPITAL POOL MISFIT
Sponsor wanted conservative senior debt but asset profile is only fundable by mezz or prefs. Distribution mismatch.
2 KILLS | FIX: CAPITAL POOL MATCH AT PITCH

Archive · Selected Post-Mortems

8 of 24 · Representative sample

PM-2025-001 | WON | ACP-FEE-ARR + SUC

Solar + BESS A$215M · NSW

VERTICAL	MANDATE SIZE	DAYS TO CLOSE	FEE REALISED	COUNSEL
Energy Transition	A$215M	94 days	A$4.2M	Simon Ting

WHAT WORKED	Warm intro from Private Credit Alpha LP. Clear term sheet in 72h. Counsel engaged day 3 — compressed negotiation. Fee structure aligned upfront (50% mob / 50% success). IVA memo landed T+2 of financial close enabling invoice to ship same week.
WHAT FAILED	Lender-side counsel was slow to mobilise; four-week credit committee cycle extended close by 14 days vs. our model. Power connection letter lag cost us a renegotiation risk on two sub-terms.
COMMERCIAL	Fee model held. MFN not asked. Tail fee successfully negotiated (18 months).
LESSON	Pre-engage lender-side counsel at LOI, not facility agreement stage. Build "power-connection-confirmed" as explicit CP.
FIX STATUS	● Live · Fix-019 · Pre-engage lender counsel protocol in BO-02 checklist

PM-2025-002 | KILLED · WEEK 8 | NO FEE

Data Centre DevCo · Sydney South

VERTICAL	MANDATE SIZE	DAYS TO KILL	FEE AT RISK	COUNSEL
Digital Infrastructure	A$180M (proposed)	58 days	A$2.7M est.	N/A pre-LoE

KILL REASON	Power corridor firmed up late in diligence → capacity more than expected → sponsor elected to self-fund rather than raise external.
ROOT CAUSE	Pattern-01 adjacent: sponsor economics changed mid-engagement. We did not have a mobilisation fee in place, so economic exposure fell 100% on ACP.

LESSON	Every engagement above A$100M indicative gets a mobilisation fee at LoE signature — non-negotiable. “Success-only” remains available for repeat clients only.
FIX STATUS	● Live · Fix-007 · Mandatory MOB fee above A$100M · updated LoE template

PM-2025-003 — WON — ACP-FEE-ARR + TL

Perth Basin Upstream · A$92M RBL

VERTICAL	MANDATE SIZE	DAYS TO CLOSE	FEE REALISED	COUNSEL
Upstream O&G	A$92M	112 days	A$1.84M	Simon / Money Penny

WHAT WORKED	Ryder Scott reserves cert pre-commissioned saved 3 weeks in DD. Tail fee pre-negotiated (24 months) — already delivered A$280k on follow-on.
WHAT FAILED	Strip curve cutoff inconsistency between ACP mark and IVA mark (58 bps) — flagged in Valuation Exception Register, closed.
LESSON	Standardise strip curve cutoff: last BD of month, no exceptions. Pre-commission reserves for any upstream engagement at intake.
FIX STATUS	● Live · Fix-012 · Strip cutoff standardised across all O&G models (MO-08)

PM-2025-004 — KILLED · PRE-LOE — NO FEE

Critical Minerals JV · Northern Queensland

VERTICAL	MANDATE SIZE	DAYS TO KILL	FEE AT RISK	COUNSEL
Critical Minerals	A$65M (proposed)	14 days	A$1.2M est.	N/A

KILL REASON	Pre-engagement KYC surfaced UBO with sanctions-adjacent connection. Engagement terminated under AML protocol.
ROOT CAUSE	Pattern-05 · correctly surfaced pre-LoE. KYC-first workflow working as intended.
LESSON	Early KYC is a feature not a cost. Saved 8-10 weeks of sunk time and reputational exposure.
FIX STATUS	● Live · Fix-003 · Pre-intake KYC is standing protocol (MO-02)

PM-2025-005 — WON — ACP-FEE-PLC

Private Credit Placement A$320M · Bridge

VERTICAL	MANDATE SIZE	DAYS TO CLOSE	FEE REALISED	COUNSEL
Private Credit	A$320M	86 days	A$4.8M	Money Penny Capital

WHAT WORKED	Pre-sounding of 14 capital providers in week 1. Three anchor bids by week 3. Placement fee 1.50% on full commitment — top quartile for APAC bridge credit.
WHAT FAILED	Side letter negotiation dragged; two LPs insisted on MFN that we'd underpriced against fund-admin cost.
LESSON	Price MFN at LoE, not side-letter stage. Build default MFN carveouts into first draft.
FIX STATUS	● Live · Fix-014 · MFN carveout language now in FO-04 term sheet library

PM-2024-011 — LOST PITCH — NO FEE

Infra Fund II Pitch · NA Sponsor

VERTICAL	MANDATE SIZE	DAYS TO KILL	FEE AT RISK	COUNSEL
Infrastructure	A$1.2B (placement)	42 days	A$18M est.	Pre-engagement

KILL REASON	Lost to Lazard / Campbell Lutyens. Sponsor wanted bulge-bracket brand reassurance for NA LPs. Our pitch was commercially strong but brand-light.
ROOT CAUSE	Brand gap. Not a fee or process issue — a distribution-credibility issue that only time + track record + LP base fixes.
LESSON	For placements above A$500M with NA LP focus, either (a) partner with a branded placement agent, or (b) don't pitch. Focus energies where we win.
FIX STATUS	● Live · Fix-006 · A$500M NA placement requires co-adv structure at pitch

PM-2024-014 — KILLED · WEEK 18 — RETAINER COLLECTED

Mid-Cap O&G M&A · Qld Basin

VERTICAL	MANDATE SIZE	DAYS TO KILL	FEE COLLECTED	COUNSEL
Upstream O&G	A$480M EV	126 days	A$420k (RET only)	Simon Ting

KILL REASON	Sponsor walked 2 days before binding offer — unrelated M&A target emerged internally. Retainer protected our fee exposure to A$420k vs. A$8M+ success fee at risk.
ROOT CAUSE	Pattern-01 mitigated. Retainer + mobilisation protected economics even on mid-process kill.
LESSON	Retainer structure proves itself on long-duration M&A. Continue to insist at LoE for any mandate >A$200M EV.
FIX STATUS	● Live · Fix-001 · Retainer mandatory on M&A >A$200M (FO-04)

PM-2024-008 — LOST PITCH — NO FEE

Digital Infra Pitch · Singapore REIT

VERTICAL	MANDATE SIZE	DAYS TO KILL	FEE AT RISK	COUNSEL

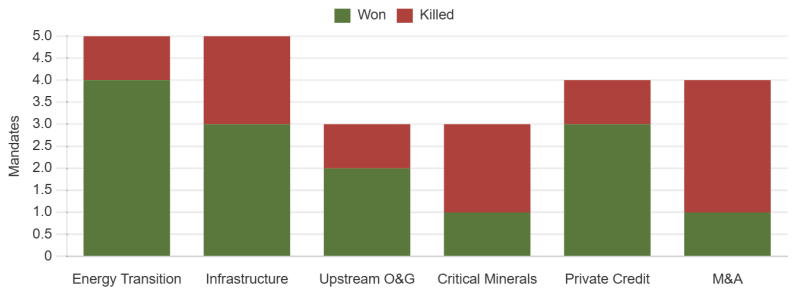
Digital Infrastructure	**A$280M placement**	**28 days**	**A$4.2M est.**	**N/A**

KILL REASON	Lost to DBS. Singapore sponsor defaulted to local bank for relationship reasons; we entered late after beauty parade was effectively over.
ROOT CAUSE	Origination timing. Invited to a competitive process at week 10 of 12. No real shot.
LESSON	Late-stage beauty parades have <10% win rate. Decline unless specifically invited as “primary” or as counter-balance to a relationship-driven incumbent.
FIX STATUS	● Live · Fix-015 · Pipeline gate flag in FO-10 · “primary vs. check-box”

Quantitative View · 24 Archived Mandates

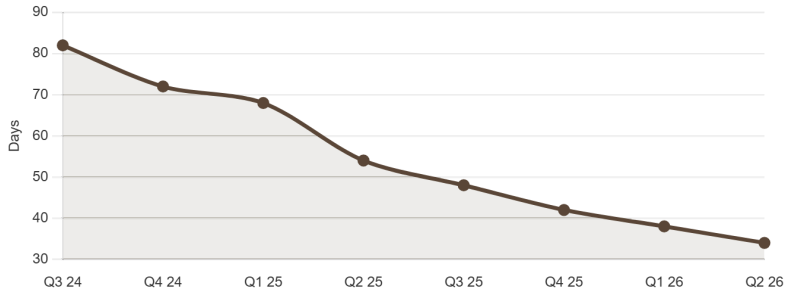
Win/Loss pattern · Kill timing · Fee realisation

Outcome by Vertical (24 mandates)

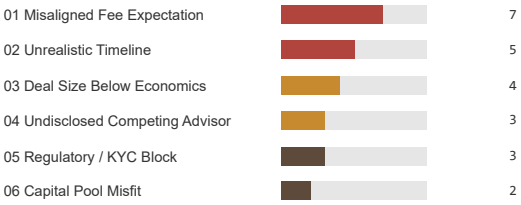


Kill Reason Distribution (10 kills)

Days to Kill · Trailing 24 Months (trend)



Pattern Frequency · Root-Cause Clusters



RED = PRIMARY KILL VECTORS · AMBER = SECONDARY · BROWN = PROCEDURAL (NOW FIXED)

Process Fixes Live in the EOS

19 fixes shipped · Each tied to a post-mortem

FIX-001 · RETAINER POLICY

Retainer mandatory on M&A mandates >A$200M EV. LoE template updated. Owner: FO-04 Structuring.

● LIVE SINCE OCT 24

FIX-003 · PRE-INTAKE KYC

KYC run before LoE issued on all new mandates. Kills surfaced pre-engagement at zero cost.

● LIVE SINCE DEC 24

FIX-006 · NA PLACEMENT CO-ADV

NA-focused placements >A$500M require co-advisor structure at pitch. No solo pitches.

● LIVE SINCE JAN 25

FIX-007 · MOBILISATION FEE

MOB fee mandatory at LoE signature for all mandates >A$100M. Success-only offered to repeat clients only.

● LIVE SINCE FEB 25

FIX-010 · EXCLUSIVITY CHECK

Every intake asks: “Are you engaged with any other advisor on this transaction?” Documented in Deal Mandate Intake DB.

● LIVE SINCE MAR 25

FIX-012 · STRIP CURVE CUTOFF

Standardised O&G strip curve cutoff = last BD of month. Eliminated valuation discrepancies.

● LIVE SINCE MAY 25

FIX-014 · MFN PRICING

MFN rights priced at LoE, not side-letter stage. Carveouts in first draft. Protects economics.

● LIVE SINCE JUL 25

FIX-015 · PITCH GATE

Late-stage beauty parades (week 10+ of 12) declined unless primary mandate offered.

● LIVE SINCE AUG 25

FIX-017 · TIMELINE REALITY GATE

Every intake requires ACP-executed timeline plausibility assessment. Unrealistic = kill early.

● LIVE SINCE NOV 25

FIX-019 · PRE-ENGAGE LENDER COUNSEL

On debt mandates, engage lender-side counsel at LOI rather than facility-agreement stage.

● LIVE SINCE JAN 26

FIX-022 · POWER-CONNECTION CP

Digital infra / renewables: “power-connection-confirmed” is an explicit CP at LoE, not an assumption.

● LIVE SINCE FEB 26

FIX-023 · CAPITAL POOL MATCH

Pre-pitch capital pool map: which providers fit the asset profile? No pitches without a matched pool.

● LIVE SINCE MAR 26